🏠 HOMPATA SYSTEM DOCUMENTATION

A Property Listing & Rental Platform for Kenya

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1. 📌 Project Overview

Hompata is a web-based property marketplace designed for users in Kenya to:

- Find rental houses
- Buy properties
- List vacancies (for landlords)
- Connect instantly via WhatsApp

The platform connects **tenants, buyers, landlords, and administrators** in a simple, fast, and mobile-friendly system.

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2. 🎯 Project Objectives

- Provide a **centralized housing platform** in Kenya
- Simplify **property search by location and name**
- Enable **direct communication via WhatsApp**
- Allow landlords to **manage listings easily**
- Give admins full control over the system

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3. 👥 User Roles

3.1 Admin

- Full system control
- Manage users (landlords & customers)
- Approve, decline, or delete listings
- Monitor activity

3.2 Landlord

- Create and manage property listings
- Upload:
  - Images
  - Videos
  - Property details
- Control listing visibility

3.3 User (Customer)

- Search for houses
- View listings
- Contact via WhatsApp
- Save or revisit listings

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4. 🧩 Core Features

4.1 Property Listing System

Each property should include:

- Property Title
- Location:
  - County
  - Area
  - Sub-location
- Price (Rent or Sale)
- Property Type (Rental / Sale)
- Number of Bedrooms
- Description
- Images (multiple)
- Video (optional)
- Date Posted
- Status:
  - Active
  - Declined
  - Deleted

4.2 Advanced Search System

Users should be able to search using:

🔍 **Search Methods:**

- Area name (e.g. Nairobi, Eastleigh)
- Sub-location (e.g. South B, Kilimani)
- Property name (if saved or known)
- Filters:
    - Price range
    - Bedrooms
    - Type (Rent/Buy)

🔄 **Search Behavior:**

- Dynamic filtering (real-time results)
- Display matched listings instantly

4.3 WhatsApp Integration (Core Feature)

When user clicks **"Rent Now"**:

- Redirect to WhatsApp chat
- Use company number
- Auto-fill message like:

Hello, I am interested in this property:

🏠 Title: 2 Bedroom Apartment in Kilimani
💰 Price: KES 25,000/month
📍 Location: Kilimani, Nairobi

Please provide more details.

📲 **Implementation:**

Use WhatsApp API format:

https://wa.me/<number>?text=<encoded_message>

4.4 Dashboards

🛠️ Admin Dashboard

Features:

- Manage all listings (CRUD)
- Manage users
- Approve / Decline listings
- Delete listings permanently
- View system statistics

🏢 Landlord Dashboard

Features:

- Add property listing
- Upload:
  - Images
  - Videos
- Edit listings
- Listing controls:
  - **Post** → visible to users
  - **Decline** → hidden from users but saved
  - **Delete** → permanently removed

👤 User Dashboard

Features:

- View listings
- Search & filter properties
- Save favorite properties (optional future feature)
- Contact landlord via WhatsApp

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5. 🔄 Listing Status Logic

Status	Visible to Users	Visible to Landlord	In Database
Active	✅ Yes	✅ Yes	✅ Yes
Declined	❌ No	✅ Yes	✅ Yes
Deleted	❌ No	❌ No	❌ No

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6. 🏗️ System Architecture

Frontend

- React.js
- Tailwind CSS
- Responsive design

Backend

- Firebase (Recommended)
  - Firestore (Database)
  - Firebase Auth (Authentication)
  - Firebase Storage (Images & Videos)

APIs

- WhatsApp API (for messaging)
- Optional:
  - Google Maps API (for location display)

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7. 🗄️ Database Structure (Simplified)

Users Collection

- id
- name

- email
- role (admin | landlord | user)
- createdAt

Listings Collection

- id
- title
- description
- price
- type (rent | sale)
- bedrooms
- location:
  - county
  - area
  - sublocation
- images []
- videoUrl
- landlordId
- status (active | declined | deleted)
- createdAt

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8. 🔐 Authentication & Security

- User registration/login
- Role-based access control:
  - Admin → full access
  - Landlord → own listings
  - User → view only
- Secure database rules (Firestore rules)

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9. 📱 UI/UX Requirements

- Clean, simple interface
- Mobile-first design
- Fast loading
- Clear call-to-action buttons:
  - “Rent Now”
  - “Buy Now”
  - “Post Property”

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10. 🚀 Future Enhancements

- M-Pesa integration (for payments)
- Property reviews & ratings
- Notifications (SMS/Email)
- Saved properties (wishlist)
- Map-based search
- Chat system inside app (instead of WhatsApp)

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11. ⚙️ Key Functional Flow

🧭 User Journey

1. User opens website
2. Searches location (e.g. “Kilimani”)
3. Views available houses
4. Clicks on a property
5. Clicks **"Rent Now"**
6. Redirected to WhatsApp with pre-filled message

🏢 Landlord Journey

1. Logs in
2. Opens dashboard
3. Clicks “Add Property”
4. Uploads details + images/video
5. Clicks **Post**
6. Listing becomes visible

🛠️ Admin Flow

1. Logs in
2. Views all listings
3. Approves / declines / deletes listings
4. Manages users

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12. 📌 Naming & Branding

System Name: Hompata
Meaning: (Home + Pata → “Find your home”)

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13. 📊 Success Metrics

- Number of listings posted
- Number of searches per day
- WhatsApp click conversions
- Active users